

Staff user manual

For **office staff, accountants, teachers and principals** using IlmForge day to day. No technical knowledge is assumed. Every instruction names the exact button you will see on screen. Part 1 is done once, in order, before the school can run. The rest are daily tasks.

Part 1 • Do this once, in order

First-time setup

The order matters. You cannot admit a student before classes exist, and you cannot generate fees before a fee structure exists. Doing it out of order is the most common cause of "the system won't let me" during training.

Step 1 • School profile

Sidebar > School Settings

- 1 Fill in **School Identity** with the school name, then **Upload Logo**.
- 2 Fill in **Contact Details**: address, phone, email.
- 3 Click **Save Profile**.

NOTE

The logo and name you set here appear on ID cards, fee vouchers, admission forms, result cards and the login page your staff and parents see. Set it properly once.

Step 2 • Academic session

Sidebar > School Settings > Academic Sessions </settings/sessions>

- 1 Click **Add Session**.
- 2 Enter the session, for example **2025-2026**, with its start and end dates.
- 3 Save. The active session shows in the top bar of every page.

Step 3 • Classes and sections

Sidebar › School Settings › Classes </settings/classes>

- 1 Under **Add Class**, type the class name (Nursery, KG, Class 1 ... Matric) and click **Add Class**.
- 2 Repeat for every class the school runs.
- 3 Under **Add Section**, pick the class, type the section name (A, B, C) and click **Add Section**.
- 4 Switch to the **Subjects** tab and use **Add Subject** to add subjects per class.

To correct a class name: click **Rename** on that row, edit it, then press Enter or click **Save**. Escape cancels. The system will refuse two classes with the same name.

Step 4 • Fee structure

Sidebar › Invoicing Hub › Fee Structure </fees/structure>

- 1 Choose the class.
- 2 Enter the monthly tuition fee and any other heads: admission fee, exam fee, transport.
- 3 Click **Save Fee Structure**.

Repeat for every class. Without this, monthly fee generation has nothing to work from.

Step 5 • Add your staff

See [Part 2](#). Add the principal, accountant and teachers before admissions begin, so students can be assigned a class teacher.

Staff and teachers

Adding a teacher or other staff member

Sidebar > Staff Directory > Add Staff </staff/new>

- 1 Fill in **Add New Staff Member** : name, father name, CNIC, phone, email, date of joining.
- 2 Click **Upload Photo** and attach a photograph. It is used on the staff ID card.
- 3 Enter the **Designation**, for example *Teacher*, *Accounts Officer* or *Security Guard*.
- 4 Choose the **Role**. This decides which portal the person gets and what they can see.
- 5 Click **Save Staff Member**.

ROLE	GETS	CAN SEE
Teacher	Teacher Portal	Their classes, attendance, marks
Accountant	Accountant Portal	Fee collection, vouchers, daily balance
Gatekeeper	Gate Portal	Gate entry, visitors, gate passes
Admin	Admin Dashboard	Everything

If you leave Role alone, the system chooses it from the designation. "Accounts Officer" becomes an accountant, "Security Guard" a gatekeeper, and anything else a teacher.

The login details: write them down immediately

As soon as the staff member is saved, a box appears with their sign-in details:

- **Portal link:** the web address to open
- **Login ID:** their email address
- **Password:** a temporary password
- **Employee code**
- **Portal:** which portal they will land in

Each line has a **Copy** button, and **Copy all** copies the whole set at once.

IMPORTANT

The password is shown only once. Copy it and hand it over before closing the box. If it is lost, an admin must reset it from the Staff Directory. The staff member should change it after first sign-in.

You can look the portal link up again any time. See [Part 8](#).

Editing or removing staff

Sidebar › Staff Directory `/staff`

Switch between **Table** and **Cards** view. Click a row to open and edit it. The Role cannot be changed here after creation, so ask an admin if someone's role must change.

Students and admissions

Admitting a new student

Sidebar › New Admission </admissions/wizard>

The wizard has five steps shown across the top. You cannot move past a step with missing required fields; those are marked with a red asterisk.

- 1 **Student Info** : name, father name, B-Form/CNIC, date of birth, gender, address, mobile number. Use **Camera** to take the student's photo with a webcam, or Browse to upload one. The two optional panels at the bottom, *Previous Institutional History* and *Health & Emergency Information*, can be filled now or later.
- 2 **Class & Section** : pick the class and section, and the class teacher if asked.
- 3 **Fee Details** : the fee comes from the class fee structure. Apply a discount here if the school has agreed one, or mark the student as free.
- 4 **Parent Details** : parent name and **phone number**. The parent signs in with this number, so enter it correctly.
- 5 **Review & Admit** : check everything, then click **Complete Admission** .

After admission: two things to print

On the success screen:

- **Print Admission Form** prints the full A4 admission form on your school letterhead, already filled in, with signature lines for parent, class teacher, coordinator and principal. Print it, get it signed, and keep it in the student's file.
- **Print Credentials Slip** prints the student's and parent's portal sign-in details. Hand this to the parent.

IF YOU MISSED THEM

Both appear only on this screen. The admission form can be reprinted any time from **Admissions › Admission Form Print** </admissions/form-print> by searching the student and choosing **Filled Form** .

Blank admission forms

Admissions › Admission Form Print, choose **Blank Form** , then **Print Blank Form** . Useful for walk-in enquiries and for keeping printed forms at the front desk.

Finding and managing students

Sidebar > Student Registry [/students](#)

Search by name, roll number or father name. Toggle **Active** / **Inactive** . **Promotion** moves a whole class up at session change.

Adding many students and staff from Excel

Sidebar > Import & Export [/settings/import-export](#)

Get the template first. Inside IlmForge, **Download template** on the Import & Export page gives you the workbook with your own classes already filled in. A blank copy is also here:

Download the Excel template .xlsx · blank

- 1 The workbook has four sheets: **Read me** , **Classes** , **Students** and **Staff** . Each sheet starts with a grey *Example* row, which is never imported.
- 2 Fill in one person per row. Leave **Roll No** and **Employee Code** blank and IlmForge creates them.
- 3 Click **Choose Excel file** and pick the filled workbook.
- 4 Read **Check before importing** . It lists every problem by sheet, row and column. Nothing is saved yet.
- 5 Click **Import** . A progress bar shows the import as it runs.
- 6 Click **Download login details** straight away. It lists every new username and password.

SHEET	COLUMNS (* REQUIRED)
Classes	Class*, Sections (e.g. A , B), Order
Students	Roll No (blank), Student Name*, Father Name*, Gender, Date of Birth, B-Form No, Class*, Section, Parent Phone, Parent Email, Mother Name, Address, Religion, Blood Group, Admission Date, Status
Staff	Employee Code (blank), Name*, Designation, Role, Phone or Email*, CNIC, Gender, Date of Birth, Department, Joining Date, Monthly Salary (Rs), Salary Type

GOOD TO KNOW

Dates are day first: **14/03/2014** is 14 March. Type phones as **03001234567**. Brothers and sisters with the same parent phone share one parent account. Importing the same file twice is safe: anyone already in the school is skipped.

Moving a school to another server

- 1 On the old server: **Import & Export > Export records**. You get one Excel file in the same format as the template.
- 2 On the new server, signed in as admin: **Import & Export**, choose that file, check it, import it.

IMPORTANT

The file carries classes, students with their parents, and staff. Fees, attendance and exam marks are not in it: use **Settings > Backup & Restore** to move the whole database.

Adding or changing a photo

- **Student:** Student Registry, open the student, **Add photo** (or **Change photo**).
- **Staff:** Staff Directory, **Edit**, click the **Add Photo** box, then save.
- **From ID Cards:** click the photo spot on a card row and pick a picture.

Any phone or camera picture works; it is shrunk automatically to about 40 KB. The same photo then appears on the ID card, the character and leaving certificates, and the portal.

SAVED ONLY ON THIS COMPUTER?

Photos added before this update may live only in one browser. Where you see that message, click **Save to records** (ID Cards) or **save it to the record** (student profile) so every computer sees it.

Online admissions: your school's own admission form

Every school on IlmForge has its own **web name** and its own pages. For Future Foundation School, for example:

PAGE	LINK	WHO USES IT
School page	<code>.../s/future-foundation-school</code>	Anyone: one link for everything
Admission form	<code>.../s/future-foundation-school/apply</code>	Parents applying for admission
Fee slip	<code>.../s/future-foundation-school/fees</code>	Parents printing a voucher by roll number

Each page shows **your** school's name, logo and colours, lists **your** classes and campuses, and sends everything to **your** school only.

Sidebar > Portal Links > Share with families `/settings/portal-links`

Each link has **Copy**, **Open** and **QR code**. The admission form's QR panel also has **Print "Admissions open" poster**: an A4 poster with your logo, name, QR code and phone number.

When a parent applies, they get a reference number such as **ADM-00042**, and the school is told at once:

- 1 The **bell** at the top of every admin page shows a red count. Open it to see *New admission application · Online form*.
- 2 The dashboard's **Needs attention** list shows applications waiting for a call back.
- 3 An email goes to the school's registered email address (when email is set up).
- 4 If IlmForge is open, a short message pops up within a minute.

Admissions > Admission Inquiries `/admissions/inquiries`

- New applications are under **New**; the arrow shows everything the parent wrote.
- Call or WhatsApp the parent with one click, then set **Contacted**, **Admitted** or **Closed**.
- **Admit** opens the admission wizard with the details already filled in and the class chosen. The inquiry is marked Admitted by itself afterwards.
- Walk-in and phone enquiries: **Add inquiry**, so every enquiry is in one list.

CHANGING YOUR WEB NAME

Portal Links > **Change web name** lets you shorten it (e.g. `future-foundation`). Links already shared with the old name, including printed QR codes, stop working, so share the new ones.

Attendance

Marking daily student attendance

Sidebar > Attendance Tracker > Student Attendance </attendance-hub>

- 1 Select class, section and the date. Today is selected by default.
- 2 Click **Start Marking →**.
- 3 Mark each student present, absent or leave.
- 4 Click **Save & Notify**.

Save & Notify saves the register *and* sends absence messages to the parents of absent students. To save without messaging, check the school's notification settings first or ask your admin.

The attendance hub shows **Attendance Not Marked**, so you can see at a glance which classes still need doing today.

Staff attendance

Attendance Tracker > Staff Attendance > Mark Attendance </attendance/staff>

Other attendance methods

METHOD	WHERE	STATUS
ID card scan (QR / barcode)	/attendance/barcode	Works: handheld scanner or camera
Photo check-in	/attendance/face-attendance	Works; a person taps the photo. It does not recognise faces
Fingerprint machine	/attendance/biometric-attendance	A physical machine cannot send punches in yet
Spreadsheet import (CSV)	/attendance/excel	Works: columns <code>date</code> , <code>rollNo</code> , <code>status</code>
Period-wise, per subject	/attendance/period	Works

Whatever the method, a student has **one** attendance record per day. A scan marks a student present only if nobody has marked them yet, so it never overwrites a teacher's *Leave* or *Absent*.

Setting up ID card scanning at the gate

Every student ID card carries a QR code and a barcode of the student's roll number. Scanning either one marks the student present.

Handheld scanner (recommended for a busy gate)

- 1 Buy any USB or Bluetooth *1D/2D* barcode scanner that reads QR and Code 39 (about Rs 4,000–9,000). It works as a keyboard; no driver is needed.
- 2 Plug it into the gate computer. Test in Notepad: scanning a card should type the roll number and move to a new line. If it doesn't, scan the *Enter / CR suffix* code in the scanner's booklet.
- 3 Sign in to IlmForge and open **Attendance > Barcode scan**. Click once in the scan box.
- 4 Scan cards. Each scan shows the student's name and photo. Scanning the same card twice is ignored.

Webcam or laptop camera

- 1 Any USB webcam (720p) or laptop camera, in good light.
- 2 Same screen, click **Start Camera** and allow camera access.
- 3 Hold the card 15–25 cm from the camera. It is read automatically.

BROWSER

Use Chrome or Edge on the <https://> address. Staff cards are not read by this screen; mark staff on Staff Attendance.

Photo check-in and fingerprint machines

Attendance Tracker > Photo Check-in shows a class's photos; the person on duty taps a photo to mark that student present. It needs no camera and does not recognise faces by itself.

FINGERPRINT MACHINES

A ZKTeco, eSSL or similar machine **cannot yet send its punches to IlmForge**. Don't buy one for this. If you already have one, copy its daily log into a sheet with the columns `date` (YYYY-MM-DD), `rollNo` and `status`, save it as CSV and load it on Attendance > Excel import. For daily use, ID card scanning is far less work.

Correcting a mistake

Attendance › Corrections </attendance/corrections>

Use this to change a register after it has been saved. Corrections are recorded, so there is a trail of who changed what.

Fees

Generating monthly fees

Sidebar > Invoicing Hub > Generate Monthly Fee </fees/generate>

- 1 Choose the month.
- 2 Click **Generate Fee for [month]**.

This creates one invoice per active student from the fee structure. Run it once a month. There are also **Generate Custom Fee** for one-off charges and **Generate Transport Fee**.

Collecting a fee

Sidebar > Collect Fee </fees/collect>

- 1 Type at least 2 characters of the student's name, roll number or father name.
- 2 Click the student in the results.
- 3 Their invoices appear. Click **Collect** on the one being paid.
- 4 Enter the amount, any discount, and the payment method.
- 5 Click **Confirm Payment**.

A receipt appears for you to print and hand to the parent. The parent is also notified automatically if messaging is set up.

NOTE

The system will not let you collect more than the amount outstanding on an invoice. If you try, it tells you the actual amount due.

Correcting a wrong amount

IMPORTANT

If the wrong amount was entered, **do not delete anything**. Scroll to the **Payments Received** panel under the student's invoices.

- **Correct**: enter the right amount and a reason. The original entry stays on record, marked *Corrected*, and a new receipt is issued.
- **Void**: cancel the payment entirely, with a reason, for example a bounced cheque.

A reason is required for both. The original is never deleted. This is deliberate, so the school always has a true record of what was collected and what was changed. Collection totals, reports and the dashboard update to the corrected figure immediately.

Following up defaulters

Invoicing Hub > Fee Defaulters </fees/defaulters>

Lists students with outstanding fees and lets you send reminders.

Other fee screens

TASK	WHERE
Edit or delete an invoice	/fees/invoices
Family voucher, siblings on one voucher	/fees/family-voucher
Discounted students	/fees/discounted
Annual fee increase	/fees/increment
Collection report	/fees/collection-report

Exams and results

Setting up exam rules (once)

School Settings › Exam Settings </settings/exam-settings>

Set **Pass / Fail Criteria** , **Grade Boundaries (%)** , **Division Thresholds (%)** and **Admit Card Instructions** . Click **Save Exam Settings** .

Exams › Result Configuration </exams/result-config>

- **Grade Configuration** : **Add Grade** for each grade band (A+, A, B ...)
- **Signatories** : **Add Signatory** for the names printed on result cards
- **Final Remarks** : **Add Remark** for the comments teachers can choose

Click **Save Preferences** .

How many terms your school runs

School Settings › Exam Settings › Exam Terms

Choose how many exam terms your school holds in a session, from 1 to 6. Most schools run two. The Exam Vault then shows one tab per term: *1st Term*, *2nd Term*, and so on up to *6th Term*.

Set this before creating exams, so each exam can be filed under the right term.

NOTE

Lowering the number later does not delete exams already recorded under a removed term. They stay in the system and reappear if you raise the count again.

Creating an exam

Sidebar › Exam Vault </exams>

- 1 Click **Add Exam** .
- 2 Enter the exam name (Mid Term, Final Term), class, and dates.
- 3 Choose the **Term** . The dropdown lists the terms your school has set up.
- 4 Save.

Entering marks

From the exam row, click **Marks** . Enter marks per student per subject and save. Teachers can do this for their own classes from the Teacher Portal.

Results and printing

OUTPUT	WHERE
Result cards	<code>/exams/:id/results</code>
Admit cards / exam slips	<code>/exams/exam-slip</code>
Gazette sheet	<code>/exams/gazette</code>
Merit list	<code>/exams/merit-list</code>
Annual report card	<code>/exams/annual-report</code>
Subject analysis	<code>/exams/subject-analysis</code>
Exam timetable	<code>/exams/timetable</code>
Question papers	<code>/exams/question-papers</code>

ID cards

Sidebar › Student Registry › ID Cards [/id-cards](#)

- 1 Choose **Students** or **Staff** at the top.
- 2 Filter by class and section if needed.
- 3 Tick the people you want cards for, or tick the box in the header row to select all.
- 4 Choose a design from the five below.
- 5 Set the **Primary** and **Accent** colours to match your school.
- 6 Add a photo for anyone missing one, using the small camera button on their row.
- 7 Click **Print [n] Cards**. The button shows how many you selected, for example *Print 12 Cards*. A preview window opens; click **Print ID Cards** in it to send to the printer.

DESIGN	SHAPE	LOOK
Academic	Portrait	Curved header, round photo
Campus Arc	Portrait	Sweeping arcs
Executive	Landscape	Photo left, QR panel on the back
Minimal	Landscape	Clean, plain
Bold Band	Portrait	Strong colour band, large QR

Every card prints front and back together, with a scannable QR code on **both** sides and a barcode of the ID. Fields with no value are left off the card rather than printed as a dash.

PRINTING TIP

Print on card stock if you have it. The cards are standard CR80 size, the same as a bank card, so they fit normal ID card holders and lanyards.

Portals for parents, students and teachers

Everyone at the school gets their own portal, branded with your school's name and logo.

Where to find the links

Sidebar › Portal Links `/settings/portal-links`

The top of this page has your public links (school page, admission form, fee slip; see [Online admissions](#)). Below them is the sign-in link for every role, with what each person signs in with:

PORTAL	SIGNS IN WITH
Admin Dashboard	Email
Teacher Portal	Email
Accountant Portal	Email
Gate Portal	Email
Student Portal	Roll number
Parent Portal	Phone number

Use **Copy** on any row, or **Copy all** to send the whole set. **Open** previews the sign-in page as that person will see it.

SAFE TO SHARE

A link only opens the sign-in page. It is not a password. What someone can see is decided by their own account, so a parent opening the Admin link still only reaches the Parent Portal.

Giving a parent access

Parent accounts are created automatically during admission. The parent signs in with the **phone number** entered in step 4 of the admission wizard. Their password is on the credentials slip printed at admission.

A common problem is a phone number typed wrongly at admission. Correct it on the student record and the parent can then sign in.

Giving a teacher access

Created automatically when you add the staff member. The details appear on screen once; see [Part 2](#). The link is always available from Portal Links.

HR, payroll and leaves

Sidebar > HR Central `/human-resource`

One screen with tabs: **Staff** **Payroll** **Attendance** **Appraisals** **Leaves** **Loans**

Running payroll

Sidebar > Payroll Manager `/payroll`

- 1 Check the month shown at the top.
- 2 Click **Generate Payroll**.
- 3 Review each staff member's salary, allowances and deductions.
- 4 Approve and print salary slips.

Other HR screens

TASK	WHERE
Leave applications and balances	<code>/leaves</code> · <code>/attendance/leave-balance</code>
Staff loans and advances	<code>/salary/loans</code>
Appraisals	<code>/staff/appraisals</code>
Departments	<code>/staff/departments</code>
Staff birthdays	<code>/staff/birthdays</code>
CV bank	<code>/staff/cv-bank</code>

Reports and printing

Sidebar › Insights Hub [/reports-hub](#)

The starting point for reports. Commonly used:

REPORT	WHERE
Fee collection report	/fees/collection-report
Attendance report	/attendance/report
Staff attendance report	/attendance/staff-report
Daily balance sheet	/accounting/balancesheet
Accounts ledger	/accounts
Defaulters	/fees/defaulters

Printing anything

Click the **Print** button on any page. Only the document prints; the sidebar, menus, search boxes and buttons are left off the paper. Table headings repeat at the top of each page in multi-page reports.

To save as PDF instead, choose **Save as PDF** as the destination in your browser's print dialog.

Certificates

Sidebar › Certificates [/certificates](#)

Student Certificates and **Staff Certificates** tabs, including school leaving, character and bonafide certificates. [/certificates/registry](#) keeps a record of everything issued.

The dashboard

Sidebar › Smart Dashboard

The banner and the Today cards

The blue banner has **Mark attendance**, **Collect fee**, **Admission** and **Export PDF**. The figures refresh by themselves every two minutes.

Below it, three cards: student attendance (teal), staff attendance (blue) and fee collected today (purple). A **TO DO** badge means some people are still not marked. Click a card to go and finish it.

Needs attention

Appears only when something is outstanding: students not yet marked, unpaid invoices, or invoices that show **more paid than billed**, usually an amount typed in the wrong unit. Each line links to where you fix it. When nothing is outstanding it says *All clear*.

Quick actions

Twelve large shortcuts to the daily jobs: Mark attendance, Collect fee, Exam Vault, New admission, Scan ID cards, Generate fee, Defaulters and more. Click **Customise** and tap shortcuts to add or remove them (up to 12), then **Done**. **Reset** brings back the standard set. Your choice is remembered on that computer for your login.

School health

A score out of 100 with the reasons underneath it. Each line shows what was measured against its target, so you can see which one is pulling the score down. Anything not yet recorded is left out rather than counted as zero, and the panel says how much of the picture it had.

The number row

Students, staff, collected today, collected this month, outstanding, unpaid invoices. Click any of them to go straight to the list behind it.

Revenue and expenses

Collected against spent for the last 12 months.

Why this result?

Explains the change from one month to the next: how much came from student numbers, from fee changes, from collection rate, and from each expense category. The figures always add up exactly to the total change.

Forecast

Appears once the school has six months of fee and expense history.

ON A NEW SCHOOL

Some panels say "*N more months of data needed*". This is normal. They switch on by themselves once there is enough history to be accurate.

Fee income forecast

Once fee income has been recorded in three different months, a dashed trend line projects the next three months and says whether income is moving up or down. A guide, not a promise.

Export PDF in the blue banner produces a clean copy for board meetings.

Who can do what

Train each person on only the parts they need. The *Training for* buttons at the top of this page use this table.

ROLE	CAN DO	TRAIN ON PARTS
Admin / Principal	Everything	All
Accountant	Fees, vouchers, defaulters, daily balance, expenses	5, 10
Teacher	Attendance and marks for their own classes	4, 6
Gatekeeper	Gate entry, visitors, gate passes	—
Parent	Their own children only: fees, attendance, results	8
Student	Their own record only	8

Roles are enforced by the system. A teacher who opens an admin address is turned away rather than shown the page.

When something goes wrong

"The server could not complete that request"

The system could not reach the server. Check the internet connection and try again. If it continues, contact your IT support. Nothing you did caused it, and no data was lost.

A page shows no records, but you know there are some

Clear any search box and filters at the top of the page. If a red message appeared, the server is unreachable; the data is not missing.

A parent cannot sign in

They must use the **phone number** recorded at admission, not an email. Check the number on the student record is correct and complete.

A student cannot sign in

Students sign in with their **roll number**, not an email.

The wrong fee amount was collected

Do not delete it. Use **Correct** or **Void** in the Payments Received panel. See [Part 5](#).

A class name is spelled wrong

School Settings > Classes > **Rename** on that row.

Printing includes the menus and buttons

Only the document should print. If menus appear, your browser may be printing an old copy of the page. Reload it and print again.

The password was lost before it was written down

An admin must reset it from the Staff Directory. Passwords cannot be recovered, only reset.

Daily routine

WHEN	WHO	TASK
Every morning	Class teachers	Mark attendance, Save & Notify
Every morning	Office	Check Attendance Not Marked, chase missing classes
Through the day	Accountant	Collect fees, print receipts
End of day	Accountant	Daily balance sheet
Start of month	Office	Generate Monthly Fee
Through the month	Office	Follow up defaulters
End of month	Admin	Payroll, review dashboard
Exam time	Teachers	Enter marks
Exam time	Office	Print admit cards, then result cards

IlmForge staff user manual · Updated October 2026 · Covers fee corrections, per-role portal links, admission form printing, ID card designs, class rename, configurable exam terms and the new dashboard.